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Research Philosophy and Methodology

Use this as a speaking guide, not a script to memorise. Keep the meaning, but say it in your own natural voice.

SLIDE 9

Research philosophy

The article does not directly state its ontology or epistemology, so this is our interpretation of its design. Reality is treated as personal and dependent on context because the study explores how managers experienced leadership. Knowledge develops through reflection and interaction between the participants and the coach. This places the study mainly within an interpretive and constructivist approach, using qualitative research to understand experience.

SLIDE 10

Research design

The research uses a qualitative descriptive case study. It is qualitative because the author wanted detailed experiences instead of numerical scores. It also uses participatory action research because Cilliers worked directly with the managers while trying to improve their practice. The case was important in itself, but the organisation also hoped the findings would guide its wider leadership development work.

SLIDE 11

Participants and coaching process

The organisation invited twenty-six managers who showed potential for advancement, and eleven volunteered. The group included seven men and four women between the ages of twenty-four and forty-one. Each participant completed ten individual coaching sessions over ten weeks. Cilliers also observed one meeting led by each participant. This produced detailed information, although the sample remained small and was based on volunteers.

SLIDE 12

From experience to findings

Cilliers used two main sources of data: his field notes and reflective essays written by the participants. He analysed the language and recurring patterns to develop six themes. Two independent psychologists reviewed the material, which helped strengthen the study. Consent and confidentiality were also addressed. Still, the same person coached the participants and interpreted the findings, so his influence needs to be considered.

HANDOVER

Finish calmly, pause, and hand over to Zeeshan Sikander.